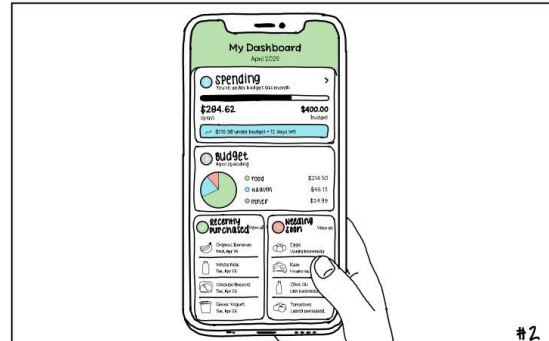


Story Boards:

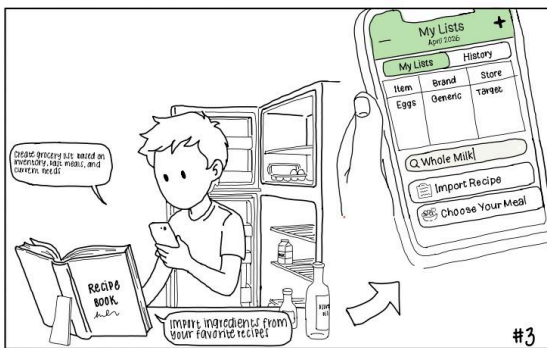
Angelique's:



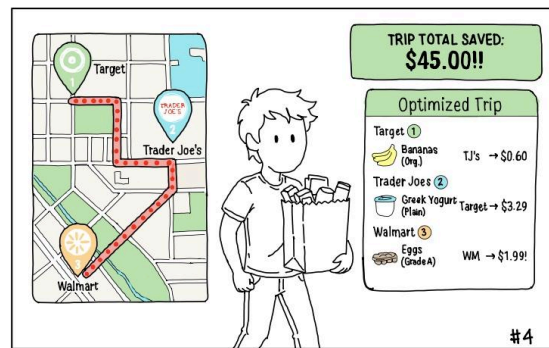
"Groceries are getting expensive, and I don't know where to shop and save money."



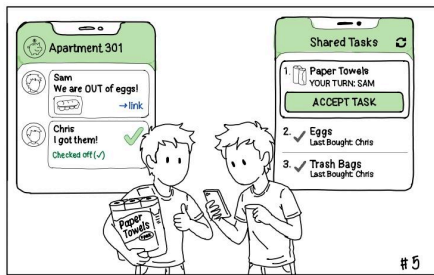
"I download an app that helps me find the cheapest grocery options and stay within my budget."



"I enter items I need, recipes/meals I like, store & brand preferences, and the app builds my grocery list automatically."



"The app finds the cheapest store for items and creates an optimized shopping route, getting me all of my groceries at the cheapest price."

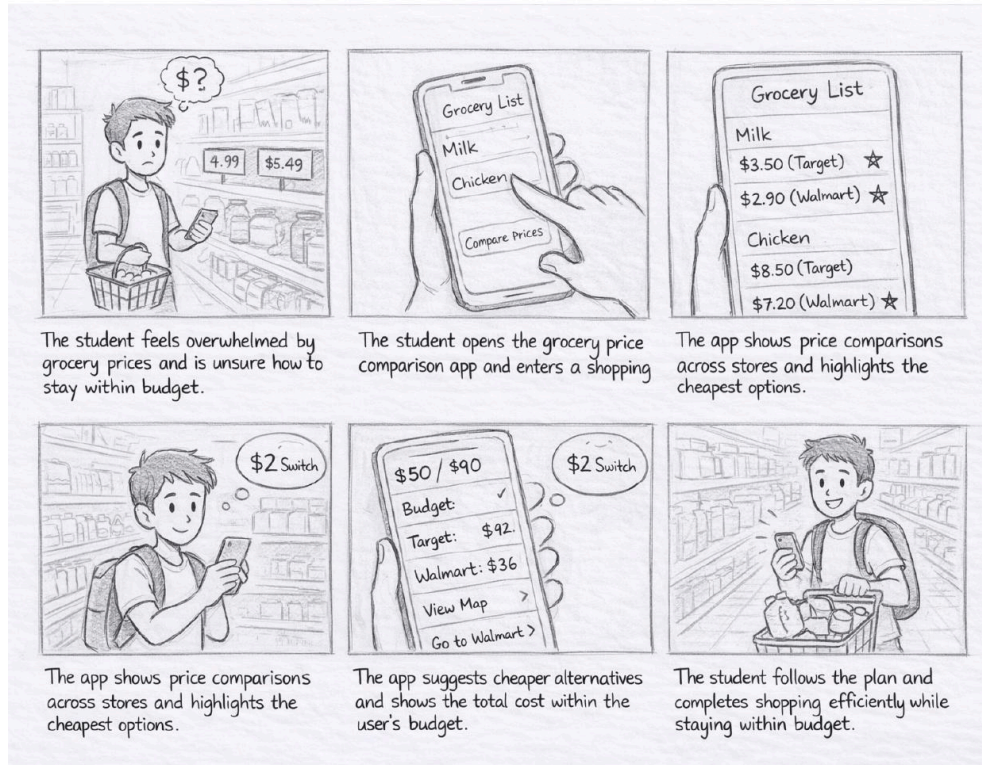


"My roommates and I share a grocery group in the app to stay on top of who's turn it is to buy shared items and prevent duplicate purchases."



"I save money, stay organized, and stick to my budget!"

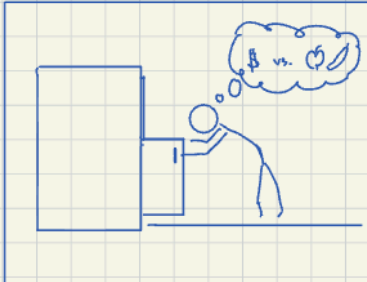
Peixin's:



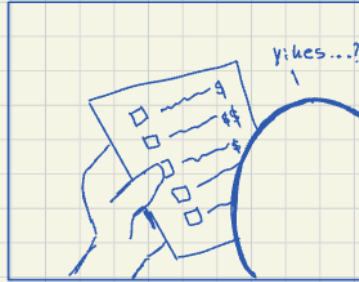
Alejandro's:

Budget Friendly Meal Planning Assistant

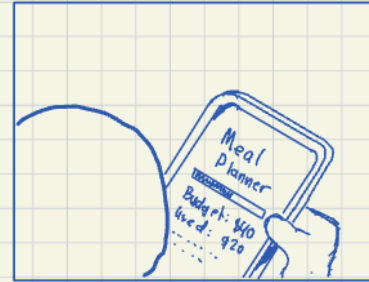
Scenario: Student planning groceries on budget.



Struggles to plan groceries within budget.



Hard to track costs and organize meals



Opens up meal planning assistant



Selects meals and sees cost instantly

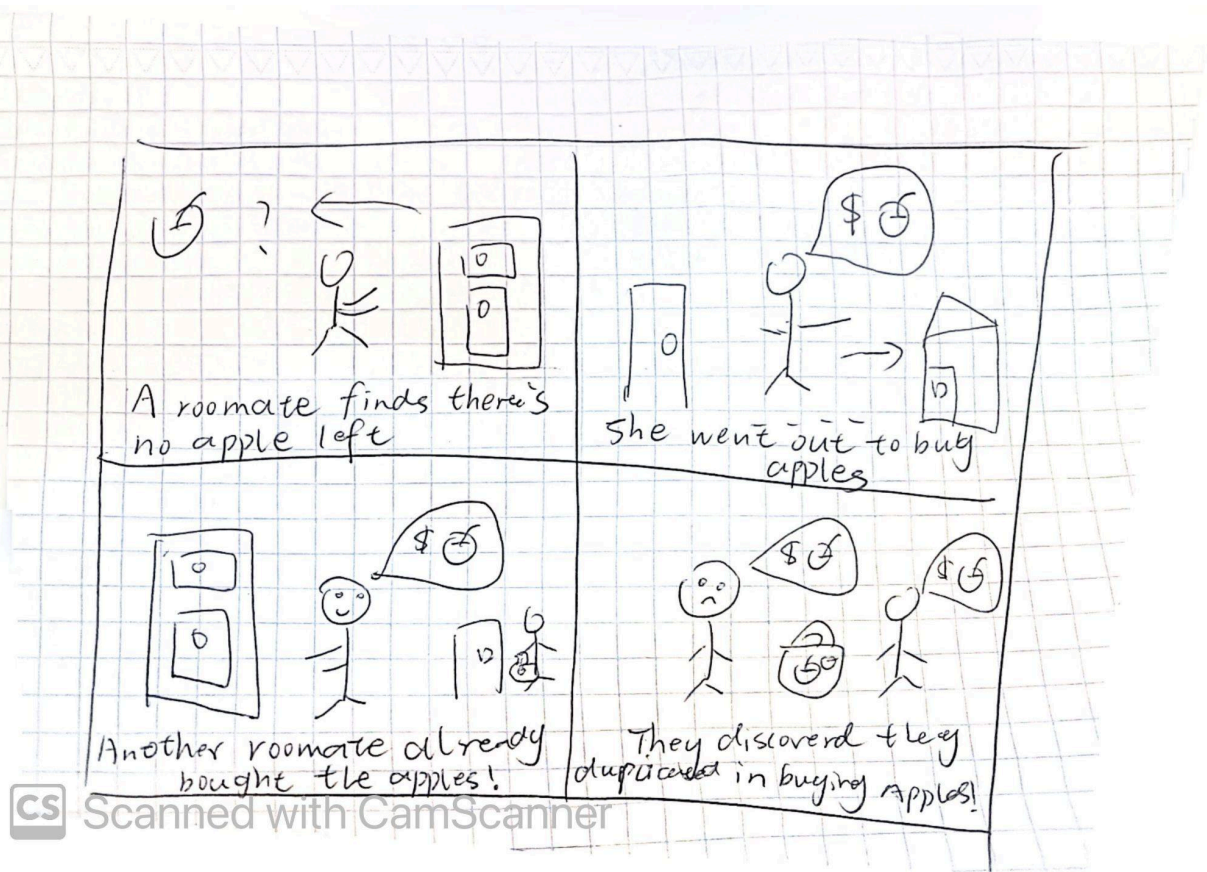


System generates optimized list

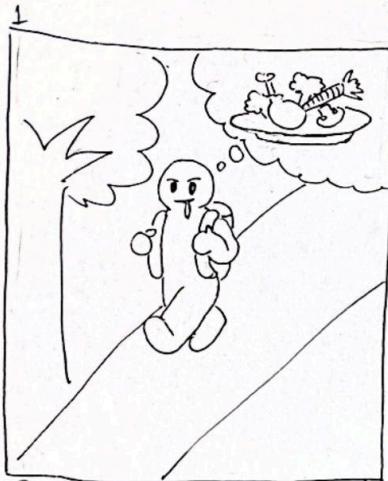


Shops confidently within budget

Helena's:



Yanbin's:



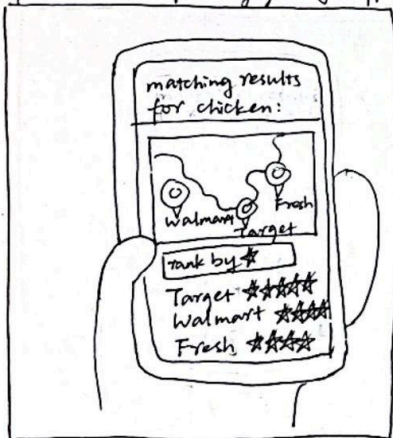
1
Students usually need to consider a lot when planning grocery shopping.



2
They need to compare prices, considering transportation, also remembering what to buy at each location.



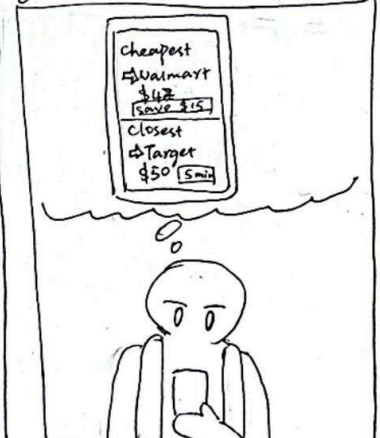
3
They can add their shopping list into the Meal Plan App.



4
It could show the users locations with the items in the list available and ranked by distance, ratings or price.



5
The users could also directly check the discounts happening in each store and send it to their friends added in the contacts.

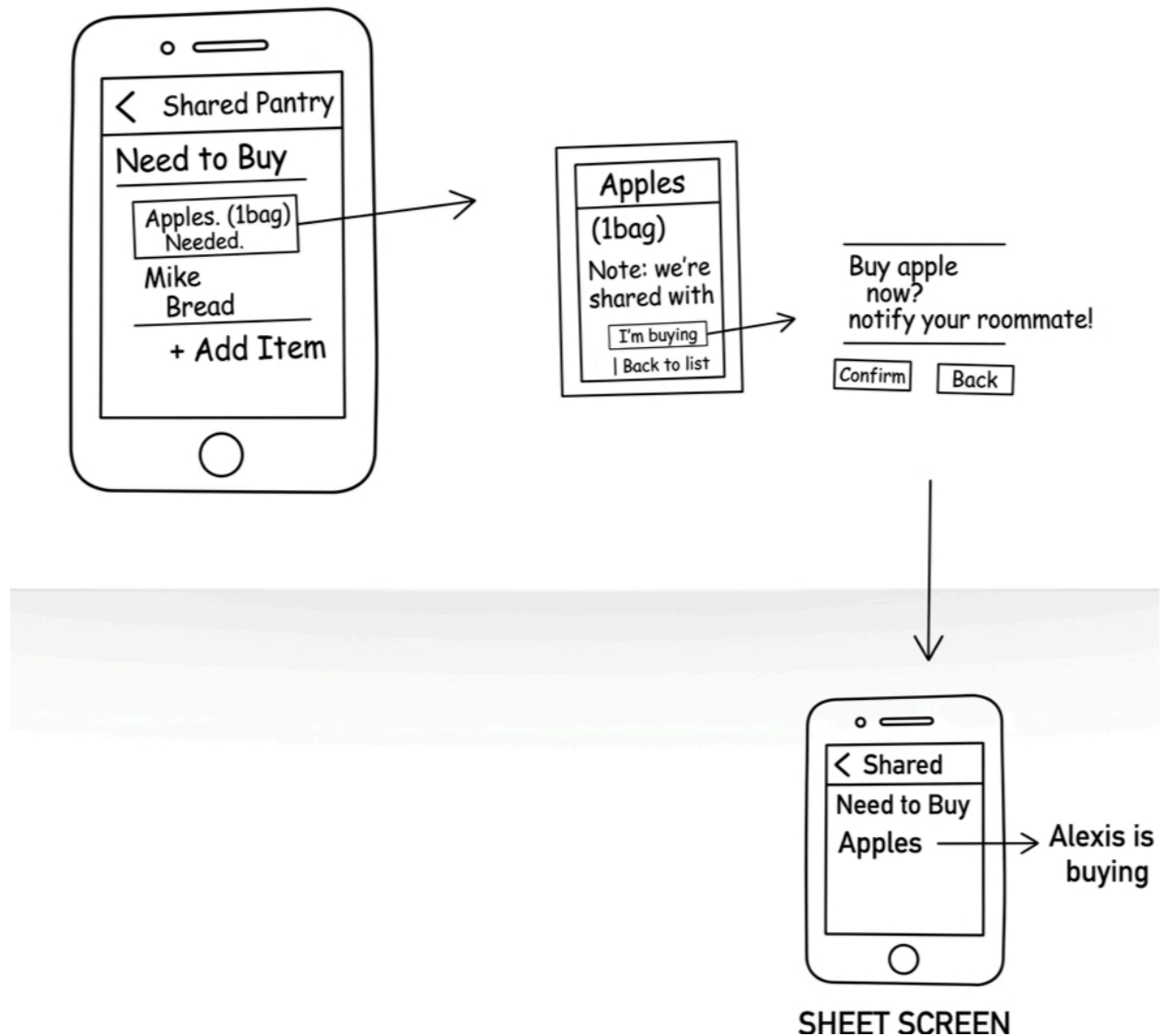


6
It helps the users to analyze and find the most optimized shopping trip in real time.



7
The students could save lots of time, money and enjoy their life with less things to worry!

Paper Prototype:



Usability Testing Summary:

We tested the prototype with friends who have experience living with roommates. Participants were able to complete the main task successfully, which was marking an item as "I'm buying this" and understanding that it would notify their roommate to avoid duplicate purchases. But we also observed a few breakdowns during the interaction. Some participants were initially unsure whether they needed to tap on the item or the button to take action. Others did not immediately notice the status change from "Needed" to "Alexis is buying," which made the feedback less clear. A few participants also hesitated at the confirmation step, as they were not sure what would happen after pressing "Confirm."

These issues might suggest that our interface could be improved by making the action buttons more prominent, clarifying the status labels, and simplifying the confirmation process. And maybe the unclear sketching is one of the reasons causing this confusion.